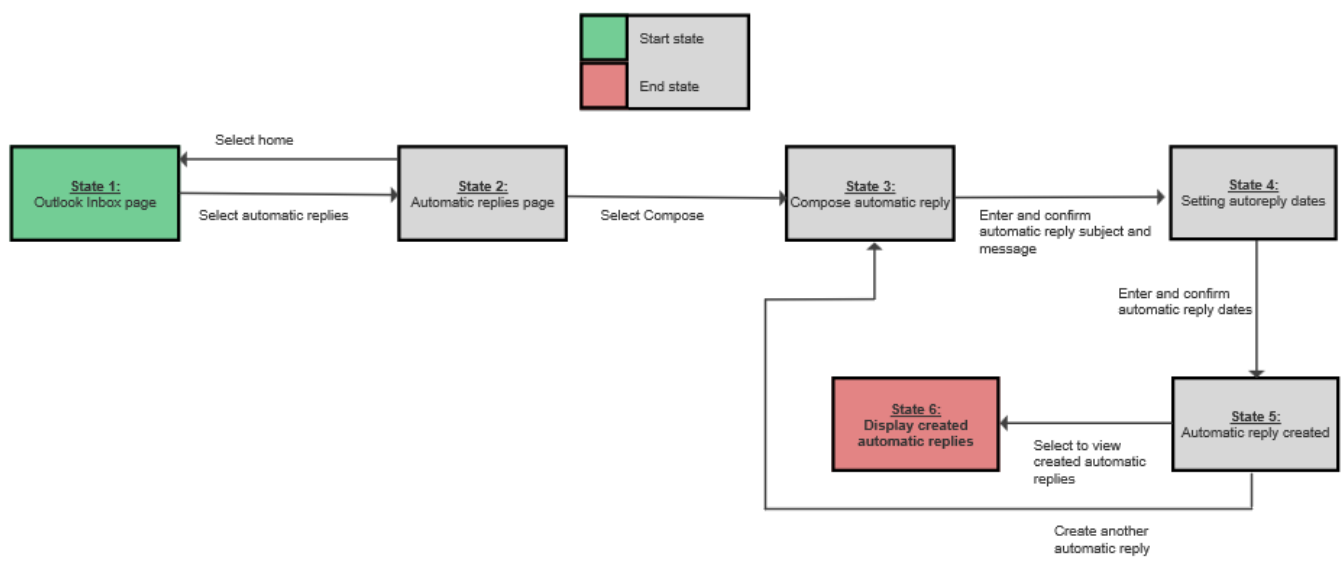
Sonny Normansell CM2101: Interface Prototyping Exercise-Individual Section –

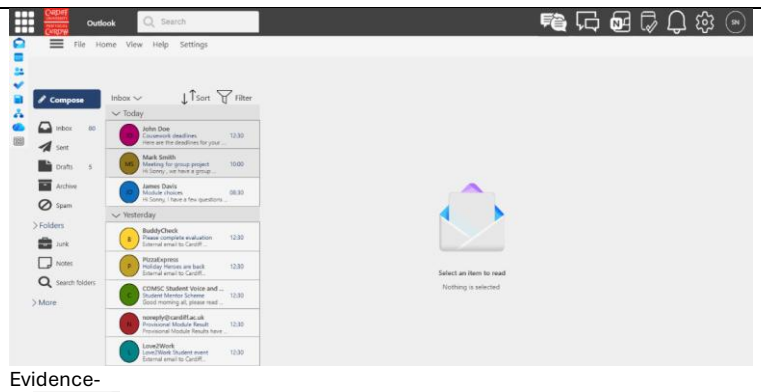
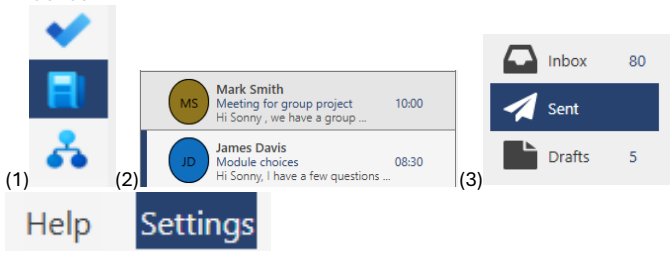
Use case -

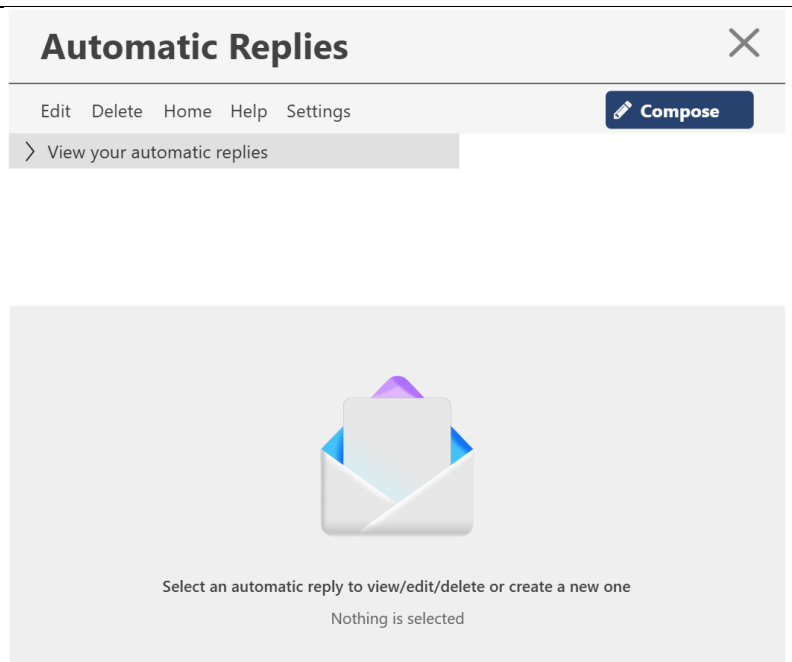
Use case Name: Set automatic Reply
Rating: Must have
Description:
User uses Microsoft outlook's automatic replies window to set one or many automatic replies to occur on specific days between specified date ranges for group of senders "inside my organization".
Pre-conditions:
The user has Microsoft Outlook open successfully.
Start condition:
User has entered Microsoft Outlooks inbox page
Basic flow:
1. The user selects the 'automatic replies' button in from outlooks inbox page 2. The user has selected the 'Compose' button 3. The user enters automatic reply subject and message 4. The user enters and confirms automatic reply dates 5. The user selects to view the automatic reply
Alternative flows:
A1. User selects settings button then selects automatic replies A2. The user searches for automatic replies in the outlook inbox page

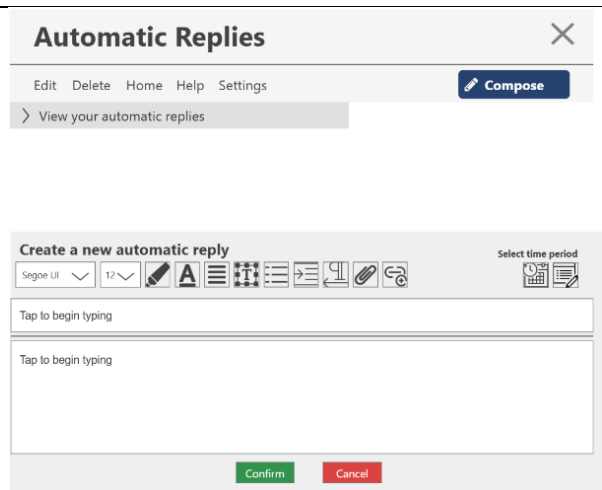
State transition network:



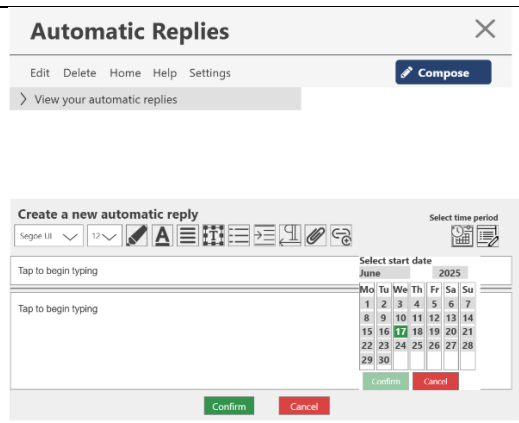
Interface prototype-

State 1 : Outlook inbox page	 Evidence-  (1) (2) (3)	**Match between system and real world** Screen design follows Nielson's 2nd usability guideline by using recognisable icons with a tooltip displaying its purpose instead of the use of technical terminology. **Contrast** Contrast was utilized in this screen design to draw attention to the unread emails by making them different to the read emails. Contrast was achieved by using a grey background colour for the unread emails and a white background colour for the read emails (2). The blue bar aligned to the left of the email that has focus provides contrast to indicate that the user is focusing on the email (2). Contrast was also utilized by making the background colour of the icons that the users cursor moves over different from the background colour of other icons on screen implying that it is the object of attention and the object the user is selecting (1)(3). **Alignment** Alignment was utilized in this screen design to unify and organise the screen ensuring that there is a visual connection between related items. For example, the emails, the buttons for email options (Inbox, sent etc) and the task option icons are all aligned in their respective sections with each email being of equal width height and with equal font-size, font-colour and font-family for text. All icons in the top navigation bar are aligned to the left. All email content has been aligned vertically for example every time label in an email is aligned vertically along with the subject, sender, message and profile picture. **Proximity** Proximity was utilized to group various related elements in this screen design , for example in the top navigation bar all the icons are in close proximity implying that they are related , the same has been applied to the hamburger menu with the file, home , view ,help and settings navigation links. **Repetition-** When hovering over an element the blue background will appear behind the element which repeats for every navigational element in the screen design. Font family has been repeated throughout the screen design using 'Sergou UI' font. Font-colour and font-size has also been repeated for example all the navigational elements under the compose button have a font-colour of #424242 and a font size of 13px which provides a visual connection between these related elements.

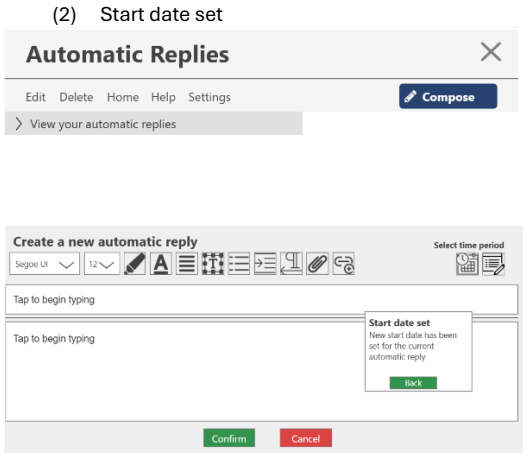
State 2 : Automatic replies page		**User control and freedom** Abides by Nielsons 3rd usability guideline by utilizing a clearly marked emergency exit denoted by the cross in the corner of the screen along with clearly visible Home and Settings buttons to exit if the user chooses this system function by mistake **Aesthetic and minimalist design** Screen design abides by Nielsons 9th usability guideline. The screen design only contains information that is relevant to the user and the tasks they can complete in the automatic replies page. **Contrast -** Contrast has been utilized to make the compose button and the 'select an automatic reply' section very different from other elements in the page. The button has a different background colour and font-colour to other elements in the page and therefore stands out as a dominant element and an object of attention which is appropriate as composing an automatic reply is the primary function of the automatic replies page. The 'select an automatic reply' section has a light-grey background which contrasts with the background of its surrounding elements, drawing focus which is important for this element as it contains a label important to helping the user navigate the automatic replies page. **Alignment –** Alignment was utilized in this screen design to unify and organise related elements on the screen. For example, the edit, delete, home , help and settings options in the navbar are aligned horizontally with equal space vertically and horizontally, they use the same font, font-size and font-colour and are visually similar. **Proximity-** Proximity was utilized during this screen design to group the navigation content (Edit,Delete,Home,Help and Settings) in the navigation bar. These elements are in close proximity to each other indicating that they are related. **Repetition-** Repetition has been utilized during this screen design to ensure consistency for example the same font-family has been repeated ('Sergou UI') which is the same font-family that has been repeated throughout every screen design. The same font-colour has also been repeated creating a visual connection between elements for example all navigational links in the navigation bar use the same font-colour #424242. **Organisers workspace design pattern** Screen design follows the organisers workspace design pattern. Screen design consists of three panels , one panel which displays automatic replies that can be selected from a dropdown, the second panel displays a brief overview of the automatic reply with options for edit and delete and the third panel shows the full automatic reply. Once an automatic reply is selected from a dropdown in the first panel, the overview of that automatic reply is displayed in the second panel with options for edit and delete and the full automatic reply is displayed in the third panel. Additionally, when selecting the edit or delete options the content of the third panel will adjust. This design pattern was useful as it allowed to display additional content related to the automatic reply with more detail in panels 2 and 3.

State 3 : Compose automatic reply		**User control and freedom** Screen design abides by Nielsons 3rd usability guideline as the dialogue contains a cancel button which can be used as an emergency exit if users accidently clicked the compose button. **Match between system and the real world** Follows Nielsons 2nd usability guideline. The screen design utilizes icons with tooltips to display the purpose of the functions in the user's language. The icons used clearly demonstrate their function and are similar icons to those used in many text editors for example Microsoft word. **Aesthetic and minimalist design** The dialogue only contains the relevant information needed to compose an automatic reply, all unnecessary features which may be useful for an email are not included in the dialogue such as the high/low priority functions. Once the user has selected the subject or message text area the 'Tap to begin typing' message disappears leaving the text areas without irrelevant or rarely needed information. **Alignment –** The icons underneath the 'Create a new automatic reply' header are aligned to create a visual connection between icons used to manipulate the content of the email and to unify and organise the screen. Each icon has been aligned horizontally to create a visual connection between the elements. **Proximity-** Proximity has been utilized to group related elements underneath the 'create a new automatic reply' header with elements related to text formatting such as the font-family and font-size drop down are in close proximity indicating a relation and the dropdowns relating to setting date ranges are in close proximity indicating a relation. **Repetition-** Repetition has been utilized in the subject and message input field. The repetition of the default content being 'Tap to begin typing' guides the user informing them of how to fill out the appropriate input fields. Repetition with regards to the size of the dropdown boxes has also been repeated with dropdowns for text formatting with the exception of font-family and font-size having a height and width of 30px. **Contrast-** Contrast has been utilized to emphasise a different functionality between the confirm and cancel button through using contrasting background colours. **Error prevention and detection-** The use of the cancel button ensures that the user can escape from this screen design preventing the user from being forced to create an automatic reply when they didn't intend to. The use of the confirm button which has a contrasting button to the cancel button ensures that the user doesn't accidently confirm an automatic reply. The use of proximity further aids error prevention as the confirm button is placed further from other elements reducing the risk of it accidently being clicked.

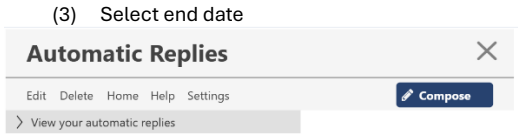
State 4 : Setting autoreply dates	(1) Select start date	**User control and freedom** Dialogue contains a cancel button as an emergency exit, if the user accidently pressed select start date they can clearly exit without going through an extended dialogue. Follows Nielsons 3rd usability guideline.

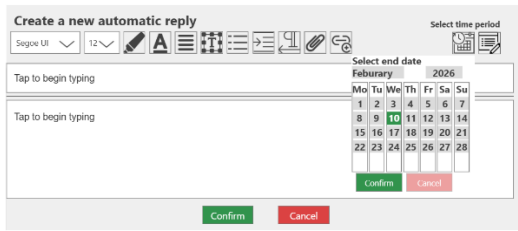


(2) Start date set

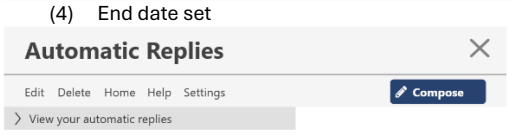


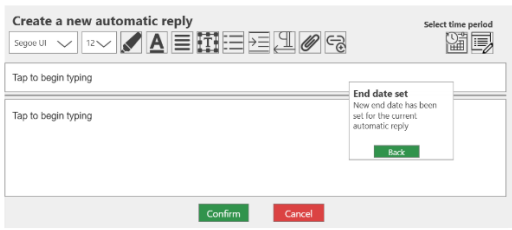
(3) Select end date



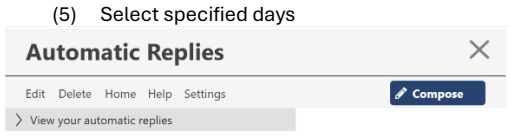


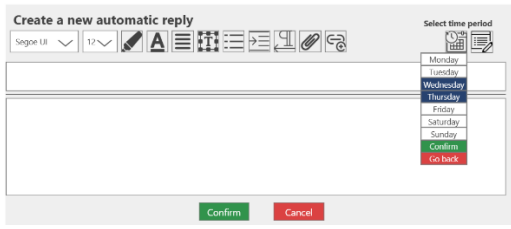
(4) End date set



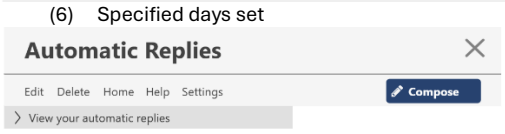


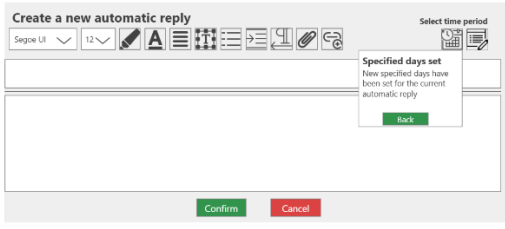
(5) Select specified days





(6) Specified days set





(5)
Go back button is clearly marked using a contrasting background. User can clearly exit If they selected the specified days option accidently. Following Nielsons 3rd usability guideline.

Magic Pixel-
(1),(3)
Utilized the concept of magic pixel to reduce the amount of time it takes for the user to travel to elements in the dropdown as the dropdown appears on the cursor.

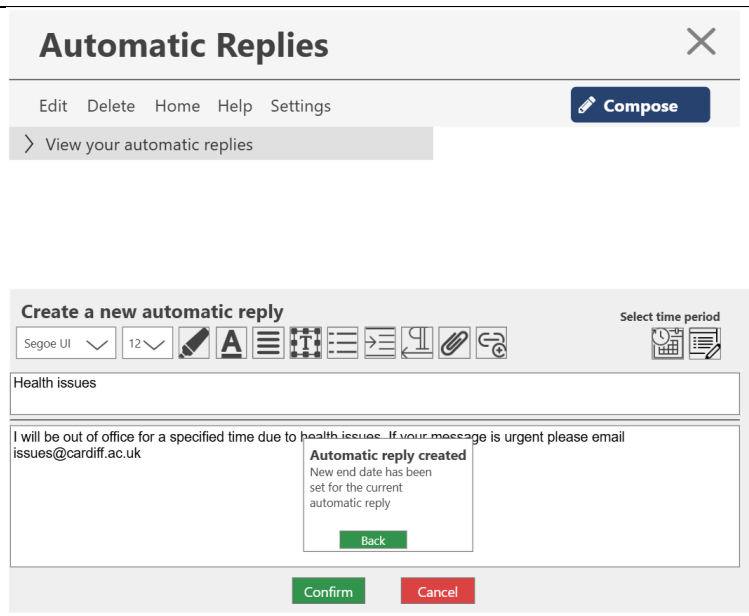
Recognition rather than recall
(1),(3)
Abides by Nielsons 7th usability guideline, once the user selects the month and year from their dropdowns it will be displayed in the same dialogue as the date therefore users do not have to remember the month and year information in the select date dialogue.

Progressive disclosure -
The individual options are displayed in the form of a dropdown box which states the available function 'set start date', 'set end date' and 'set specified dates' with more functionalities being displayed once an option is selected.
Presents only the minimal needed information initially and then provides more information for example to also select the month and year for the start date.

Magic Pixel-
Dropdowns and popups appear at the cursor reducing the time it takes for the user to move their cursor to the elements in the dropdowns and popups
Contrast
(1),(3)
Contrast has been utilized in this screen design to make the selected date (the object of attention) different from the other dates in the date picker. This focuses the user's attention on the selected date. Contrast was also utilized for the date, the month and year that the user's cursor is hovering over which draws the user's attention to the date, month or year that they are selecting. Contrast has been achieved through using a different background colour and font colour for the selected date, month and year in comparison to the unselected dates, months and years.
Contrast was also utilized for the confirm and cancel buttons. Giving them contrasting backgrounds and therefore implying that they are objects of attention.
(5)
Contrast has been utilized in this screen design to make the selected days of the week along with the days of the week that the users cursors hover over different from non-selected days of the week.
Contrast has been achieved through applying a different background colour and font colour to the objects of attention.
Alignment –
(1),(3)
Each date in the date picker has the same width and height and the same distance between. These dates are aligned to create a visual connection displaying the dates as a unified and organised group of elements.
(5)
Each day of the week, the confirm and 'go back' button have the same width and height, font-size and font-family. These elements are visually aligned to group the elements and create a visual connection.
Visibility of system status
(2),(4),(6)
Confirmation box which is displayed once the user confirms the start/end date/specified days keeps the user informed about the current system state and 'what is going on'. Abides by Nielsons 1st usability guideline.

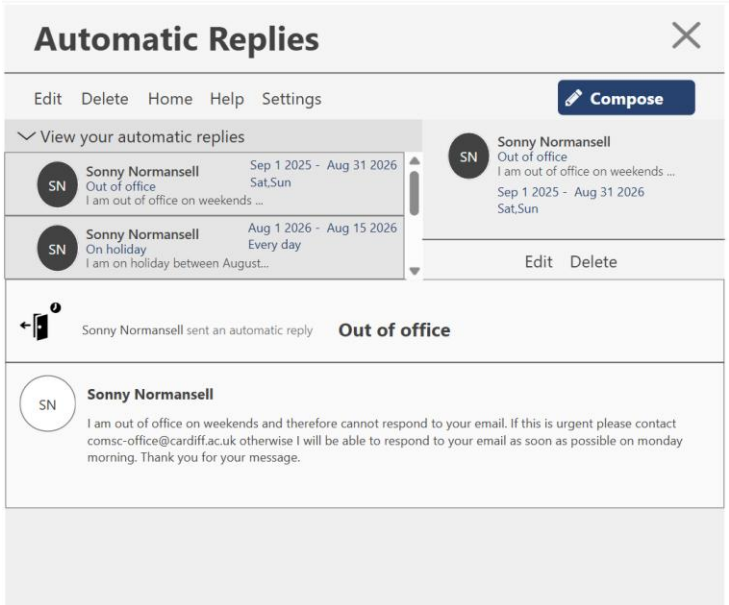
Error prevention and detection-
(5)
Using a contrasting background for the selected and focused specified days prevents the user from making an error with regards to accidently selecting incorrect days. Additionally the Go Back button allows the user to exit the dropdown , therefore if the user accidently navigated to this dropdown then they will not be required to select specified days which could lead to error.
(1), (3)
Displaying the selected date in green ensures that the user wont accidently select a date that they didn't intend to select and ensures that the user is informed about the selected date therefore reducing the risk of inputting an incorrect date.
Additionally once a start/end is selected the user cannot select another start/end date preventing the error of having multiple start and end dates for a single automatic reply

State 5:
Automatic reply created



Visibility of System Status
Design adheres to Nielsons 1st usability guideline. Popup keeps user informed about what it going on /the system state
Contrast-
Contrast was applied to make the button 'back' stand out and the element of focus , guiding the user through the interaction.
Recognition rather than recall-
When the popup appears, all information is on screen, users don't need to remember anything. The popup clearly states what happened

State 6:
Display created automatic reply



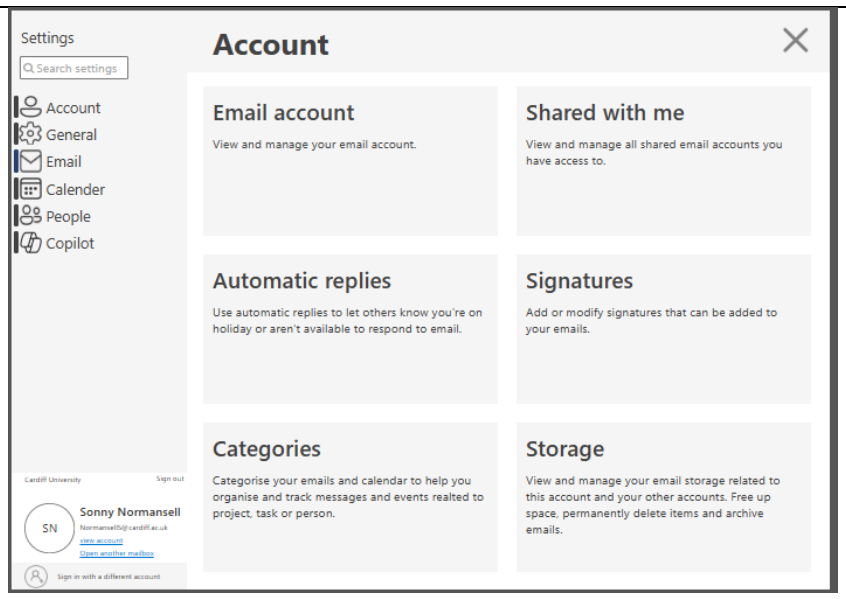
Progressive disclosure -
Initially only the minimal information needed which includes the brief overview of the automatic reply is displayed. Upon clicking the automatic reply from the 'view your automatic replies' drop down more information is presented as secondary features for example the option to edit and delete and a more detailed overview of the automatic reply.

Alignment-
All text in the automatic replies preview and in the automatic reply with options have the same font-family and font-size and are aligned. The Edit and Delete button are aligned with equal distance from the end of the container , same font-family, font-colour and font-size to group these elements visually, separating them from the content of the email with options. Each automatic reply in the 'view your automatic replies' dropdown are consistent regarding font-size, font-family spacing and are aligned vertically to unify all created automatic replies.

Organisers workspace design pattern
Screen design follows the organisers workspace design pattern. Screen design consists of three panels , one panel which displays automatic replies that can be selected from a dropdown, the second panel displays a brief overview of the automatic reply with options for edit and delete and the third panel shows the full automatic reply. Once an automatic reply is selected from a dropdown in the first panel, the overview of that automatic reply is displayed in the second panel with options for edit and delete and the full automatic reply is displayed in the third panel. Additionally, when selecting the edit or delete options the content of the third panel will adjust. This design pattern was useful as it allowed to display additional content related to the automatic reply with more detail in panels 2 and 3.

Alternative flows

A1:
User selects settings button then selects automatic replies



Progressive disclosure –
This screen design supports progressive disclosure through initially showing only a few of the most important options , those options being the group of settings options such as Account, General, Email etc. Upon selecting one of the most important options the content of the main panel will change to include the individual options within these settings groups for example email account and automatic replies for the account option group.

Error prevention -
The description of the option under every option helps prevent the user from making an error and selecting a setting that they didn't intent to navigate to by ensuring the user is informed about the setting option and can decide whether they want to go to that setting option based on some helpful information.

User control and freedom -
The exit arrow in the top right of the screen ensures that the user can backtrack the
outlook inbox page.

Visibility of the system status -
Once opening a new section of the settings page for example account, general,email etc the heading of the page will indicate which section the user is currently in. The blue vertical line next to the icon representing which section the user is in also supports this usability guideline.

Alignment-
All panels in the main content are aligned vertically and horizontally, creating a visual connection between panels, indicating that they are related to the same settings option.

Grid of equals design pattern-
The grid of equals design pattern has been implemented in this screen design. This design pattern ensures that each option in an individual settings option is presented with equal visual importance, utilizing the same size and spacing meaning none of the options is visually prioritised over the others. This design pattern ensures that the layout feels organised , reduces visual clutter which will improve the overall readability of the screen design allowing the user to identify the options quicker as they are presented in a structured format. The grid of equals design pattern in this screen design also provides a predictable interaction as every element follows the same format which will allow the users to quickly learn that every option is clickable and opens a new page.

Repetition-
Repetition regarding font-family has been utilized in this screen design, the font family 'Sergou -UI' has been repeated throughout this screen design which is consistent throughout every other screen design. Repetition has been implemented for each panel in the main content with every heading

		being bold and having a font-size of 24px and every paragraph within the panel having a font-size of 13px and a regular font weight. Each panel's size is also 315px x 160px ensuring consistency and alignment. Each icon in the right hand navigation bar is of equal size ensuring consistency and aesthetics. **Contrast-** When the user hovers over a panel in the main content the panels background colour will change to a darker shade of grey providing the user with feedback on what option they are about to select